Not long after we moved into the White House, Nancy happened to be in the Lincoln Bedroom on the second floor, and she noticed that one of the pictures on the wall, one that was said to have been a favorite of Abe Lincoln, was turned, hanging crooked. Nancy started to straighten it and a maid who was in the room at the time said, “Oh, he’s been here again.”

Later, one of the White House butlers said that he had heard music coming from the direction of the piano in the hall, and as he approached, it stopped.

Well, we’d heard the legend that Lincoln’s ghost haunted parts of the second floor and took it all with a grain of salt. Then something happened involving our dog, Rex, that nearly made me join the believers.

One night we were sitting in the living room of the family quarters when Rex suddenly stared down the length of the Central Hall toward the other end of the building. His eyes were fixed straight ahead and his ears stood up as straight as two flagpoles.

I looked out and couldn’t see anything. Rex started barking loudly and edging slowly down the hall while I kept an eye on him. He got about halfway down the hall and then stopped and seemed to be looking at something in front of him. It made me wonder: Is there something out there I can’t see from my angle?

By now, I was really curious, so I went down to where he was and I said, “Come on, Rex, come on back,” trying to persuade him to return to the living room. But he just stayed where he was, feet firmly planted, with that same fixed stare in his eyes and still barking. By then, I was down the hall almost to the Lincoln Bedroom, so I turned and went into it. Rex got as far as the door and stopped; he stopped barking and, with a deep growl, started backing away from the door. When I tried to get him to come into the bedroom,